

Success With Your Orthodontic Appliance

Today you have started another stage of your active orthodontic treatment – your orthodontic appliance has been placed. Treatment results depend greatly on your cooperation. Now that you've started orthodontic treatment, there are a few key matters you need to keep in mind.

FOODS

- Avoid all sticky foods, including Starburst, Skittles, Airheads, Now and Laters, Good & Plenty, Mike and Ikes, Hot Tamales, Licorice, Gummy Bears, Milk Duds, Taffy, etc.
- You may chew gum or use a breath mint that is sugar free. We highly recommend gum or breath mints that contain Xylitol (Xylitol must be the first ingredient on the label) 3 to 5 times per day. Xylitol is a healthy, natural cavity-preventing sweetener that has been used in foods since 1960. The gum may be chewed for 5 to 10 minutes after meals and snacks. We recommend Epic gum, which is available for sale at the front desk.
- Avoid hard foods including hard candies, nuts, and ice.
- Limit sugary drinks, like pop/soda, diet pop/soda, Kool-Aid, sugared fruit juices, energy drinks, Powerade, and Gatorade. While water is the best choice, you can still enjoy Propel fitness water and Gatorade G2 which are much lower in sugar.
- Cut apples, carrots, celery, bagels, and pizza into bite-sized pieces to avoid breaking your appliance.

ORAL CARE

- Use ClinPro 5000 toothpaste every night. Brush for 2-3 minutes and spit out the excess toothpaste. Do not rinse your mouth and do not eat or drink for at least 30 minutes.
- The fluoride treatment helps prevent decalcification from occurring by strengthening the enamel.
- Use Crest ProHealth mouth rinse once a day in the morning after brushing your teeth.
- Place the wax provided by our office on spots that are bothersome to your cheeks and lips. Sugar-free gum may also be used.

Instructions: Take a small piece from the container and roll it into a ball. Then, push it onto the bothersome area. Make sure to take the wax out before you brush your teeth or eat. If you accidentally swallow some wax, it will not hurt you. If you run out of wax, please let our office know. You can stop by to pick up more wax, or if more convenient, wax can be mailed to you. You also can purchase some at stores such as Wal-Mart or Walgreens. If you prefer to use sugar-free gum: chew up a piece of gum, roll a small piece into a ball and place it onto the bothersome area. Also, with the gum, remember to remove it before eating.

- **Brush your teeth three times per day.** It is vital to your treatment. Brushing eliminates plaque and prevents decalcification from occurring. Make sure to angle your toothbrush so that it gets around each bracket and under the wire. The doctor and assistants will monitor brushing at every appointment. If there are any problems or concerns with brushing, it will be discussed with you and/or your parent/guardian.
- Flossing is also important to maintain good dental hygiene. Flossing should be done once a day. You will receive floss and will be taught how to tie the floss to the threaders and how to floss your teeth with orthodontic appliances in place.

BROKEN APPLIANCE

If your appliance breaks or you have concerns with it, call the office during regular business hours. In case of a true emergency after hours, call our office to be directed to our emergency line.



☐ Separators

Today we have placed separators between your teeth. These small elastics will create the space needed for future bands. You will be able to brush as normal. Please avoid sticky foods. Often times, the separators will fall out. If this happens, you can use floss to simply glide the separator back in. If there is too much space, and the separator continually falls out, it means we have successfully created the space we will need. Periodically try and re-insert the separator up until the day of your next appointment. If a separator comes out 1 day before your appointment and you can't get it to stay in, it is fine to leave it out.

☐ Headgear

Headgear reduces over bite and/or opens the bite. If headgear is worn with braces, it encourages the teeth to move back and properly align. Your headgear should be worn 10 to 12 hours a day. You should start your headgear on the second notch and then move the strap up to the fourth notch by your next appointment. At your next appointment you will then be advised on how to continue to wear your headgear. Make sure to bring your headgear to every appointment. Your headgear will make your teeth hurt the first couple of days. Advil or Tylenol will help. If you are faithful with the headgear and wear correct hours, pain will go away after 3-4 consecutive days of wearing.

☐ Expander

An expander widens your upper and/or lower palates. It will create space between your two front teeth. Don't worry: this space will close as treatment progresses. You will learn how to turn the expander, how many times a day to turn it, etc. When brushing, it's important to make sure you brush the expander, expander bars and the area around it. If you experience any inflammation or irritation of tissue around your expander continue to brush and massage tissue and alternate warm salt water rinse with Peroxyl rinse 2 to 6 times a day until affected area is feeling better. If problem persists please contact our office. It is also important to floss under expander. Using floss threaders tie floss to threader. Use threader to get floss under expander. Then run floss back and forth under expander to clean out and food residue. Also using proxy brushes that will be given to you when expander is placed will help keep under the expander clean and tissue healthy.

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